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Graduate Recruitment Team

Point72

London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Point72 Academy Investment Analyst Program for Upcoming Graduates (2027 – UK) in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. The Point72 Academy's ten-month programme, which teaches statistics, modelling and coding before analysts join investment teams, is the most structured route I have found from academic research to holding a real investment view.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 694 anomaly portfolios across 54 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 53, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, estimates petro-currencies' oil betas from OPEC announcement-day surprises, tests whether Norway's krone conversions, Russia's 2017–22 budget rule and Mexico's put hedge make them smaller, kinked or one-sided, and asks whether any beta that remains survives costs and a White reality check. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

Hedge funds appeal to me because the distance between an idea and its consequences is short: a research view becomes a position, and the position is marked every day. I take that accountability seriously. As Vice-President and then President of the Strathclyde Poker Society, I taught new members to use the Kelly criterion to work out how many buy-ins their win rate, variance and risk tolerance call for, with a buffer because their edge is only an estimate; a position sized on an uncertain alpha needs the same caution. As Treasurer of the Agricapital Society, which I helped grow to 126 members, I manage its budget and accounts.

The Point72 Academy stands out to me because it treats training as a real investment: eight months of formal teaching in company analysis, modelling, data analysis and coding, followed by rotations with investment teams, with more than 230 Academy graduates placed at the firm as of March 2026. My CAPM work showed me how rarely an apparent edge survives proper testing, and I would like to learn how Point72's analysts build fundamental views that do.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan